Natural Resources Committee Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers
100 Ribaut Road,
Beaufort, SC 29902

Tuesday, February 3, 2026
4:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/373961

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Glover called the meeting to order at 4:00 PM

Present
Committee Chair York Glover
Committee Member Gerald Dawson
Committee Vice-Chair Lawrence McElynn
Committee Member Anna Maria Tabernik - Virtual
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Committee Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

Absent
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Mark Lawson

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Glover led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Glover stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 7:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Dawson, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair McElynn to approve the minutes from November 3, 2025.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 7:0.

6. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken.

7. Assistant County Administrators Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/373961

8. Presentation and Discussion Items

a. Discussion of Funding to allow for Subsidies of Impact Fees for Qualified Affordable Housing pursuant to Ordinance 2015/28 and Chapter 82 Section 33 of the Beaufort County General Code of Ordinances.

The vote at County Council on January 12, 2026 - 7:4
Council referred this item back to the Natural Resource Committee during the liaison and committee report at the County Council meeting on January 12, 2026

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member McElynn to send this item to County Council to create a special revenue fund in the amount of $30,000 to amend the budget.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Ex-Officio Howard, and Committee Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Committee Member Tabernik, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 5:2.

9. Agenda Items

a. Approval to fund due diligence and negotiate terms of acquisitions for the following proposed Green Space Program applications: Pine Grove Plantation Tracts, Harper Tracts, Palmetto Bluff-Pioneer Land & Timber Tracts, Broad Creek Marina Tract **(FISCAL IMPACT: Green Space Program Fund Account #4706 (fund balance as of January 9, 2026 - $$95,862,062):**
   1. **Pine Grove Plantation Tracts - $25,000**
   2. **Harper Tracts - $25,000**
   3. **Palmetto Bluff – Pioneer Land & Timber Tracts - $50,000**
   4. **Broad Creek Marina Tract - $25,000)** - Mr. Mike McShane, Chair of Green Space Advisory Committee & Mr. Mark Davis, Green Space Program Manager (15 minutes)

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Chair Glover to approve the approval to fund due diligence and negotiate terms of acquisitions for the following proposed Green Space Program applications: Pine Grove Plantation Tracts, Harper Tracts, Palmetto Bluff-Pioneer Land & Timber Tracts, Broad Creek Marina Tract.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 7:0.

b. A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Open Land Trust, for a conservation easement on property located in the Town of Hilton Head Island known as the Simmons Tracts (pin# R510 010 000 0008 0000, R510 010 000 0647 0000), not to exceed ($1,545,000). **(FISCAL IMPACT: Up to $1,545,000 from the Green Space Program Fund Account #4706-10-0000-54400. Fund account balance as of January 9, 2026 - $95,862,062)** - Mr. Mike McShane, Chair of the Green Space Advisory Committee

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Chair Glover to approve a Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Open Land Trust, for a conservation easement on property located in the Town of Hilton Head Island known as the Simmons Tracts (pin# R510 010 000 0008 0000, R510 010 000 0647 0000), not to exceed ($1,545,000).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 7:0.

c. An ordinance amending the Zoning map for 5 acres (R300 016 000 0063 0000, R300 016 000 0064 0000, R300 016 000 0065 0000) from T3HN to T4VC **(FISCAL IMPACT:)** - Rob Merchant, Planning and Zoning Department Director

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve an Ordinance amending the Zoning map for 5 acres (R300 016 000 0063 0000, R300 016 000 0064 0000, R300 016 000 0065 0000) from T3HN to T4VC for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals and policies of the Comprehensive Code and the purposes of the Development Code; it is not in conflict with provisions of the Development Code and out Code of Ordinances; it does address a demonstrated community need; it is not required by changed conditions; it is compatible with existing and proposed use of land surrounding this land; it would not adversely affect nearby land; it would result in logical and orderly development patterns; it would not result in adverse impact on the natural environment (water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment); and it would result in the development that is adequately served by public facilities (streets, potable water, sewer, stormwater management, solid waste collection and disposal, schools, parks, police, fire, emergency medical facilities).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Member Dawson, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 6:0.

*Committee Chair Glover recused himself

10. Adjournment

Ratified: April 6, 2026